

The 5 intellectual virtues are understanding, knowledge, craftsmanship, intelligence and wisdom. From these, the craftsmanship (techne) is (in my opinion) the easiest to distinguish from the rest as it is about the physical production of things. This includes things like the arts, sculpting, architecture, and making medicine. Wisdom (phronesis) refers to one's ability to make good actions. This could very easily be confused with techne but I think the distinguishing factor is that techne concerns itself with actions whose end is beyond itself (ie the end of the product) whereas phronesis is concerned with actions whose end is itself. Or more simply, phronesis is concerned with actions themselves and techne is concerned with matters of production. In the text, it is stated that "Hence the reasoned state concerned with action [phronesis] is different from the reasoned state concerned with production [techne]"¹. These were the two I started with first as they are concerned with the particulars and are not timeless facts. On the other hand, the other intellectual virtues (understanding [sophia], intelligence [nous], knowledge [episteme]) are concerned with more theoretical universal ideas. Of these, the most straightforward is perhaps the idea of nous which I think I better understand as one's intuition as it pertains to the "terms which are not the result of reasoning"². In other words, nous relates to things we learn through our intuition without much need to ponder thoroughly to understand. Next it follows that episteme are the things learned through some form of derivation or demonstration as "knowledge involves reasoning"³. Knowledge is a very important virtue because it is a virtue that is able to be taught and learned. Understanding however is probably the area I think is most unclear to me. The text simply states that "understanding must be intelligence combined with knowledge, being knowledge of the most valuable things which has, as it were, been crowned"⁴. From this definition, it appears that sophia is a union of episteme and nous, but this seems weird to me as it diminishes the whole idea of categorizing sophia as its own intellectual virtue if it is simply the joint union of two other virtues.

¹Aristotle's *Nicomachean Ethics*, 119

²Aristotle's *Nicomachean Ethics*, 125

³Aristotle's *Nicomachean Ethics*, 121

⁴Aristotle's *Nicomachean Ethics*, 122